Established in 1968, the Government Dental College and Hospital, Nagpur, is one of India's premier centres for dental education, research and oral healthcare. Since its inception, the institution has trained more than 3,000 dental graduates, who are now practising across India and abroad. GDCH is located on the grounds of Government Medical College, Nagpur, one of the largest medical campuses in Asia. In this year's Best Colleges Survey, the institution climbed from 12th place in 2022 to 8th, making it the most improved college in its category.

The annual intake capacity for the Bachelor of Dental Surgery (BDS) programme has increased from 30 students at the inception to 63 now. Apart from Master of Dental Surgery (MDS) programmes in all recognised dental specialities, which were introduced beginning 1981, the institution added PhD programmes in 2014 and fellowship programmes in 2017 in various advanced disciplines.

"We have a legacy of 60 years. NEET toppers prefer this college. We have good research activities at the undergraduate and postgraduate levels," says Dr Mangesh Phadnaik, dean. The college also regularly conducts faculty enhancement workshops. "We have abundant clinical material. We also have advanced diagnostic and treatment modalities," he adds.

As a tertiary referral centre for oral healthcare, GDCH Nagpur caters to nearly 300,000 patients annually. The institution is equipped with modern clinical and laboratory infrastructure, including CAD (Computer-Aided Design)-CAM (Computer-Aided Manufacturing) technology, 3D printing facilities for surgical guides, a modular operation theatre, advanced diagnostic and surgical equipment, contemporary dental units and specialised treatment facilities. Outreach services are provided through mobile dental units and satellite centres, ensuring access to oral healthcare for underserved populations. Since 2017, the institution has conducted over 1,000 outreach camps, benefiting more than 75,000 people. During the Covid-19 pandemic, the institution established a pioneering centre for the treatment and rehabilitation of mucormycosis patients.

GDCH Nagpur has also launched the country's first-of-its-kind super-speciality dentistry and research centre. This state-of-the-art facility brings advanced disciplines such as aesthetic dentistry, digital dentistry, oral implantology, sports dentistry and forensic odontology under one roof. The centre is equipped with a modern simulation laboratory, an advanced digital library, a central museum and ICT-enabled smart classrooms to support high-quality education, training, innovation and research. Unique initiatives such as the Students Training Assessment Rating (STAR) system and the Reflection Logbook have strengthened outcome-based education and learner assessment. The college also offers career-oriented add-on courses aimed at enhancing employability and professional competence. It is expected to emerge as a national hub for super-speciality dental education, advanced patient care and translational research, says Dr Phadnaik. In its first cycle of assessment by the National Assessment and Accreditation Council (NAAC), the institution achieved the prestigious A+ grade with an outstanding CGPA of 3.33.

For final-year BDS student Komal Rewatkar, GDCH Nagpur has provided strong clinical exposure. "We are always taught that dentistry is an art and science, and skill is very important," she says. Modern teaching methodologies such as self-directed learning have helped students develop confidence and presentation skills, adds Rewatkar, who has represented the institute at various national and international conferences. "Outreach activities help students understand rural populations better and generate new research ideas."

Research, innovation, intellectual property generation and publication activities by faculty and students form a core part of the institution's academic culture. GDCH Nagpur has developed a vibrant undergraduate research ecosystem that encourages students to undertake research projects under mentors of their choice, promoting scientific inquiry and critical thinking. ■

TOP 5 MOST IMPROVED COLLEGES DENTAL

RANK	COLLEGE	CITY	RANK 2026	RANK 2022
1	GOVERNMENT DENTAL COLLEGE & HOSPITAL, NAGPUR	Nagpur	8	12
2	DR. HARVANSH SINGH JUDGE INSTITUTE OF DENTAL SCIENCES & HOSPITAL	Chandigarh	17	24
3	GURU NANAK INSTITUTE OF DENTAL SCIENCES & RESEARCH	Kolkata	27	37
4	FACULTY OF DENTAL SCIENCES, IMS, BHU	Varanasi	3	4
5	CHETTINAD DENTAL COLLEGE & RESEARCH INSTITUTE	Kanchipuram	40	53

***The college that has shown the highest improvement in rankings between 2022 and 2026**